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SILICON PUSH
PM Narendra Modi at Micron's semiconductor facility, Sanand, Feb. 28

▶ INDIA SEMICONDUCTOR MISSION

THE NEXT CHIP LEAP

Semicon 2.0 raises India's ambitions from attracting global chipmakers to building a domestic semiconductor ecosystem across design, manufacturing, research and talent

By M.G. ARUN

THE CENTRE HAS RAISED THE STAKES IN ITS SEMICONDUCTOR AMBITIONS with the launch of Semicon 2.0. Backed by a Rs 1.27 lakh crore budget, it aims to move India beyond attracting global chipmakers towards building a semiconductor ecosystem. As the next phase of the India Semiconductor Mission, it focuses on deepening domestic capabilities across chip design, manufacturing, packaging, research and talent, while strengthening India's position in an industry that has become central to economic competitiveness and national security.

Tiny chips power virtually every modern technology—from smartphones, computers and telecom equipment to automobiles, medical devices, defence platforms and AI systems. According to market research firm IDC, global semiconductor revenues are expected to cross $1 trillion (Rs 96 lakh crore) in 2026. India's market, estimated at $45-50 billion (Rs 4.3-4.8 lakh crore), is projected to